

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	6 — The Age of Reorganisation
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: the Maurya empire broke up from within (not destroyed by foreign invasion), so internal weakness preceded and caused the foreign entry into the northwest; never swap Gandhara (Greco-Buddhist, wavy hair and toga-folds) with Mathura (indigenous, spotted red sandstone, fuller forms); the Satavahanas and Tamil kingdoms reached Rome by SEA while the Kushanas profited from the LAND Silk Route; foreign rulers were absorbed into a dominant Indian culture rather than erasing it; an ashvamedha or matrimonial alliance is a political act, not merely a ritual or a wedding; royal women (mother-names, land-donating queens, a queen's horse-sacrifice) held real power; a stupa is a Buddhist dome, an anicut a river-dam, a samvat a counted era; and keep the dynastic order straight (Maurya breakup, then Satavahanas, then Kanishka). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A debater argues that the Age of Reorganisation deserves that name rather than 'the Dark Centuries after the Mauryas'. Which single piece of evidence, if true, would MOST weaken the 'Dark Centuries' label?

- (A) A single emperor reunified the whole subcontinent and ended all rivalry between kingdoms
- (B) Every kingdom of the period was governed by foreign rulers who suppressed local life
- (C) Across these centuries new schools of sculpture, busy long-distance trade and enduring Sanskrit literature all flourished
- (D) The period left behind no coins, inscriptions or monuments for historians to study

2. Which chain of reasoning correctly links the end of the Mauryas to the arrival of foreigners in the northwest?

- (A) Foreign armies attacked first, and their pressure is what broke the empire apart from outside
- (B) The Mauryas and the incoming foreigners governed the subcontinent jointly until both faded together
- (C) The foreigners were invited in by the Mauryas to help defend the frontier they could no longer hold
- (D) Internal weakness broke up the empire first, and the resulting weak frontier then allowed foreign rulers to move in

3. A student writes: 'Because the invasions came AFTER the Mauryan breakup, the invasions cannot be the breakup's main cause.' This argument is sound chiefly because:

- (A) foreign invasions are always less important than internal politics in any empire's history
- (B) the invaders and the Mauryas were in fact the very same people under different names
- (C) a cause must come before its effect, so an event that follows the collapse cannot have produced it
- (D) the northwest where the invaders entered had never belonged to the Mauryan realm at all

4. Pushyamitra's path to power and the Indo-Greeks' entry into India are best contrasted as:

- (A) two simultaneous foreign invasions that together destroyed the Maurya empire
- (B) a peaceful royal inheritance versus a popular election among the nobles
- (C) two indigenous Tamil powers expanding northward out of the far south
- (D) an internal coup inside the Mauryan establishment versus an outside people moving into a weakened frontier

5. Which one-line description of the period's political map is the MOST accurate?

- (A) a single empire even larger than the Mauryan one that preceded it
- (B) one foreign empire stretching unbroken over the whole subcontinent
- (C) a land emptied of organised states for several centuries on end
- (D) many competing kingdoms across different regions rather than one large empire

6. Two long-warring kingdoms become firm allies the year after a princess of one weds the prince of the other, and they thereafter campaign together. A historian should treat the marriage primarily as:

- (A) diplomacy carried out through matrimony, turning a rivalry into an alliance
- (B) a strictly private family event with no consequence for relations between the two states

- (C) a religious sacrifice performed mainly to win the favour of the gods
- (D) a device by which the stronger kingdom collected yearly tribute from the weaker one

7. A king frees a horse to roam for a year with his army following, then performs a great sacrifice over the lands it crossed unchallenged. The act most resembles, in purpose, which of the following modern gestures?

- (A) holding a vote to choose who should succeed to the throne
- (B) signing a treaty of marriage that binds two royal houses together
- (C) fixing the first day of a brand-new dated calendar
- (D) a public declaration claiming supreme overlordship of all the territory one could reach unopposed

8. An inscription records that a WIDOWED Satavahana queen herself performed the ashvamedha. Two conclusions are drawn: (i) royal women could wield real authority, (ii) the Satavahanas still kept Vedic ritual. Which is correct?

- (A) only the first follows; her performing the rite says nothing about whether Vedic ritual survived
- (B) only the second follows; a queen could perform the rite without holding any real power
- (C) neither follows; the record concerns trade rather than ritual or authority
- (D) both conclusions follow soundly from this single record

9. A Satavahana king is called 'Gautamiputra', and inscriptions separately record his mother Gautami Balashri donating land. The STRONGEST single conclusion that BOTH facts together support is:

- (A) kings of the age were customarily named after the chief god each one worshipped
- (B) 'Gautami' was the name of the dynasty's original founding city in the Deccan
- (C) royal women stood high enough that kings could be named after their mothers and queens could endow gifts
- (D) the king had renounced his throne to take vows as a Buddhist monk

10. Which set of three facts, taken together, most directly OVERTURNS the belief that 'only kings ever held power in these kingdoms'?

- (A) mother-derived royal names, land-donating queens recorded in inscriptions, and a queen's performance of the ashvamedha
- (B) ship-coins, Roman gold hoards and Silk-Route milestones
- (C) the Bharhut Stupa, the Heliodorus pillar and the Grand Anicut
- (D) Sangam poems, the Shaka calendar and Kanishka's many-gods coins

11. Why is the ashvamedha a BETTER illustration of 'politics expressed through ritual' than an ordinary temple offering would be?

- (A) it was performed only once in all of Indian history and so was uniquely memorable
- (B) it was the only ritual ever performed by women rather than men
- (C) its very procedure stakes a territorial and sovereignty claim over the lands the horse crossed
- (D) it required no priests, so the king alone controlled its political meaning

12. It seems puzzling that the Vedic-reviving Shungas adorned the Buddhist Bharhut Stupa. The puzzle dissolves once we accept that, in this age:

- (A) the Shungas had secretly converted to Buddhism while pretending to revive Vedic rites
- (B) a ruler favouring one tradition could still sponsor fine art for a different one
- (C) the Bharhut Stupa was actually a Vedic temple that historians have mislabelled
- (D) Buddhism had already died out, so the stupa was merely an empty monument

13. On a labelled map, the territories of the Shungas and the Satavahanas should be shaded, respectively, in:

- (A) the Deccan plateau for the Shungas, and north-central India for the Satavahanas
- (B) the Tamil far south for the Shungas, and Kalinga for the Satavahanas
- (C) the northwest frontier for the Shungas, and the Central Asian steppe for the Satavahanas
- (D) north and central India for the Shungas, and the Deccan plateau for the Satavahanas

14. A reference card reads: 'Stupa = tall free-standing victory pillar.' Which correction is needed?

- (A) a stupa is a dome-shaped Buddhist monument, often ringed by carved railings and reliefs
- (B) a stupa is a low dam built to divert a river into irrigation canals
- (C) a stupa is an anthology of early Tamil love-and-heroism poems
- (D) a stupa is a counted calendar era reckoned from a fixed starting event

15. Which dynasty-and-deed pairing is the ONLY correct one?

- (A) the Shungas — building the Grand Anicut across the Kaveri delta
- (B) the Shungas — controlling the overland Silk Route through Central Asia
- (C) the Shungas — reviving Vedic ritual and adorning the Bharhut Stupa
- (D) the Shungas — minting coins carrying Greek-style royal portraits

16. Suppose a Shunga-era Bharhut railing and an Indo-Greek silver coin survive from roughly the same century. Which contrast between them is accurate?

- (A) the railing is Buddhist religious art of the heartland, while the coin is the chief portrait record of a northwestern foreign ruler
- (B) both are works of the indigenous Mathura red-sandstone school

- (C) both were produced by foreign rulers descended from Alexander's governors
- (D) both are sea-trade tokens used to pay for Roman pepper

17. A Satavahana coin stamped with a two-masted ship, found near a Deccan port, is BEST used to argue that the dynasty:

- (A) worshipped the sea as a god and stamped its image for devotion
- (B) had lost all of its land territory and survived only at sea
- (C) had built a war-fleet specifically to fight the Kushanas in the north
- (D) carried on a thriving maritime trade through its western ports

18. The Satavahanas and the Kushanas both grew rich from trade, yet a careful comparison shows their wealth flowed through:

- (A) the overland Silk Route for both dynasties alike
- (B) western SEA routes for the Satavahanas and the overland LAND Silk Route for the Kushanas
- (C) western sea routes for both dynasties alike
- (D) the overland Silk Route for the Satavahanas and western sea routes for the Kushanas

19. Roman gold coins keep turning up along Indian trade ports, but historians do NOT conclude that Rome ruled India. The best reason is that:

- (A) the coins were certainly forgeries made in India and never reached India from Rome
- (B) Rome was too far away for any of its goods or coins ever to reach India
- (C) Indian kings minted those coins themselves inside Roman mints
- (D) coin finds show commercial exchange, whereas political rule would need evidence such as Roman governors or garrisons

20. Why is a queen's land-grant inscription a MORE reliable source for women's standing than a poem praising a generous queen would be?

- (A) an inscription records an actual act with a fixed wording, while a praise-poem may exaggerate to flatter
- (B) poems from this age were never written down and so cannot be studied at all
- (C) inscriptions were always written by the queens themselves in their own hand
- (D) praise-poems were forbidden by law and so none of them survive

21. Kharavela is called a 'monk-king'. The label is best explained by saying he:

- (A) ruled Kalinga as its king while himself being a devout follower of Jainism
- (B) abdicated his throne to wander the land as a homeless monk
- (C) served as a Kushana governor of Gandhara in the far northwest
- (D) founded an entirely new monastic religion of his own creation

22. Almost all we know of Kharavela comes from one rock-cut record, the Hathigumpha inscription. This dependence best illustrates that, for this age, historians often must:

- (A) rely on continuous written chronicles kept year by year at every court
- (B) depend on Roman trade ledgers that listed each Indian king
- (C) reconstruct a ruler's deeds from writing carved into lasting material
- (D) use Tamil Sangam poems composed in honour of eastern kings

23. An 'inscription' and a 'coin' are both physical sources, but the chapter values them for DIFFERENT strengths. Which statement captures the difference correctly?

- (A) inscriptions are modern forgeries while coins are genuine ancient objects
- (B) coins are written chronicles while inscriptions are pictures only
- (C) inscriptions often record a ruler's deeds and gifts in words, while coins often preserve a ruler's name, titles and portrait
- (D) neither can tell us a ruler's name, so both are useless for identifying kings

24. Kharavela's Kalinga and the Satavahanas' realm are best distinguished as lying, respectively, in:

- (A) the Deccan plateau and the Tamil far south
- (B) the eastern coast region of Kalinga and the Deccan plateau
- (C) the northwest frontier and the Central Asian steppe
- (D) the Tamil far south and north-central India

25. Which list names ONLY the three crowned Tamil kingdoms of the southern country?

- (A) Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas
- (B) Shungas, Satavahanas and Chedis
- (C) Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas
- (D) Mauryas, Nandas and Guptas

26. A visitor expects Sangam poems to read like a manual of Vedic sacrifice and is surprised. The poems in fact mostly celebrate:

- (A) the step-by-step procedures of the ashvamedha rite
- (B) the titles and campaigns of the Kushana emperors
- (C) the customs duties charged along the overland Silk Route
- (D) love, heroism and the giving of gifts

27. Sangam poems repeatedly praise chiefs for open-handed giving. The most reliable conclusion a historian can draw about the Tamil south is that:

- (A) rulers were forbidden by law from giving away any gifts
- (B) generous gift-giving was prized as a mark of a worthy ruler
- (C) wealth was shared equally so that no chiefs existed at all
- (D) poetry there dealt only with Vedic sacrifice and never with chiefs

28. Which region-and-power pairing is correct for this age?

- (A) the Deccan — the Cholas
- (B) Kalinga — the Cheras
- (C) the northwest frontier — the Pandyas
- (D) the Tamil far south — the Pandyas

29. Why are Roman writers' detailed notes on Tamil-coast pepper treated as evidence of TRADE rather than of conquest?

- (A) knowledge of a region's goods can come purely from buying them, without any political control
- (B) Roman writers only ever described lands their armies had conquered
- (C) the notes prove that Tamil kings ruled provinces inside Italy
- (D) the notes show Roman colonists had founded the southern kingdoms

30. Both the Satavahanas and the Tamil kingdoms reached the Roman world. The correct comparison is that:

- (A) the Satavahanas reached Rome by land and the Tamils by sea
- (B) the Tamils reached Rome by land and the Satavahanas by sea
- (C) both reached Rome chiefly by sea trade rather than by any overland route
- (D) both reached Rome along the overland Silk Route through Central Asia

31. A museum gallery titled 'India and the Wider World' holds a Satavahana ship-coin, a hoard of Roman gold from a Tamil port, and a Kushana Silk-Route milestone. The single idea uniting all three is that the age:

- (A) saw India militarily conquered by Rome and China alike
- (B) kept India's commerce confined within its own borders
- (C) funnelled all of India's foreign contact through one single route
- (D) linked India to distant lands through both sea and land trade

32. The Grand Anicut (Kallanai) on the Kaveri is best classified as:

- (A) a stupa raised over relics of the Buddha
- (B) a coastal fort built to block Roman ships from the ports
- (C) an ancient dam that spread the river's water across the delta
- (D) a free-standing Greek-style victory pillar

33. Why did the Grand Anicut matter so much to Chola prosperity, while a coastal fort would NOT have served the same purpose?

- (A) the anicut irrigated the delta into rich rice land, the agricultural base of the kingdom's wealth
- (B) the anicut was the dynasty's main military stronghold against rivals
- (C) the anicut barred enemy ships from sailing up the Kaveri to the capital
- (D) the anicut marked the fixed boundary line with the neighbouring Pandyas

34. A glossary defines 'anicut' as 'a counted calendar era beginning from a fixed event'. The correct definition is:

- (A) a dome-shaped Buddhist monument ringed with carved railings
- (B) a treaty of marriage binding two royal houses together
- (C) writing carved into stone to record a ruler's deeds
- (D) a low dam that raises river water so it can be diverted into irrigation canals

- 35.** The Indo-Greeks who pushed into the northwest traced their origin to:
- (A) the Shunga kings of north-central India
 - (B) the Chedi rulers of Kalinga in the east
 - (C) the Greek governors and settlers who remained in the region after Alexander's campaigns
 - (D) the Kushana emperors of the Central Asian steppe
- 36.** The Heliodorus pillar was set up by a GREEK ambassador to honour an INDIAN god. As a single object it is most powerful for proving that the Indo-Greeks:
- (A) imposed Greek gods on every Indian subject they ruled over
 - (B) blended Greek and Indian culture, even adopting Indian beliefs
 - (C) refused all contact with Indian religion and worship
 - (D) demolished Indian shrines wherever they held power
- 37.** Indo-Greek coins are prized by historians for a reason that does NOT apply to most other evidence of these kings. That reason is:
- (A) the coins were never actually used in trade and so stayed perfectly preserved
 - (B) the coins were all minted inside the city of Rome itself
 - (C) the coins carried the Tamil Sangam poems written out in Greek letters
 - (D) with few inscriptions surviving, the coins supply most of what we know, including the rulers' names and portraits
- 38.** The fact that the Indo-Greeks could enter and rule parts of India at all is itself best understood as a CONSEQUENCE of:
- (A) an invitation extended to them by the Chola kings of the south
 - (B) the Kushanas having built the Silk Route especially for them
 - (C) the weakening of the northwest frontier following the Mauryan breakup
 - (D) the official launching of the Shaka era calendar
- 39.** A coin shows a Hellenistic-style royal portrait on one face and an Indian deity named in Indian script on the other. This single object best supports the conclusion that its foreign issuer:
- (A) rejected Indian languages and gods altogether
 - (B) merged Greek conventions with Indian ones rather than keeping the two apart
 - (C) ruled the whole subcontinent under one uniform coinage
 - (D) took no interest in trade or money of any kind
- 40.** Which statement about the foreign rulers in India during this age is the MOST accurate?
- (A) they erased Indian culture and replaced it entirely with their own
 - (B) they were largely absorbed into Indian culture, which remained the dominant influence
 - (C) they stayed wholly apart and mixed with nothing Indian at all
 - (D) they unified the whole subcontinent under one lasting foreign empire

- 41.** Assertion: the foreign rulers are usually counted among contributors to Indian civilisation rather than its destroyers. Reason: Indian culture stayed dominant and reshaped much of what the newcomers brought. Which is correct?
- (A) the assertion is true but the reason is false
 - (B) the assertion is false though the reason is true
 - (C) both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion
 - (D) both the assertion and the reason are false
- 42.** That foreign rulers' coins and art ended up with 'Indian themes always at the heart' is best read as showing that India:
- (A) violently expelled every trace of foreign influence from its art
 - (B) absorbed and reshaped the newcomers rather than being erased by them
 - (C) was wholly Hellenised and lost its own cultural identity
 - (D) halted all artistic activity for the duration of the foreign presence
- 43.** The Shakas who settled in India are also referred to as the:
- (A) Indo-Greeks
 - (B) Indo-Romans
 - (C) Indo-Scythians
 - (D) Indo-Cholas
- 44.** That India's official national calendar still counts years from the Shaka era is best used to argue that this age:
- (A) left lasting marks on Indian life rather than leaving only ruins
 - (B) produced nothing that outlived its own time
 - (C) was entirely the creation of Roman officials
 - (D) had no genuine contact with Indian traditions
- 45.** A 'samvat', the kind of thing the Shaka era is, is best defined as:
- (A) a low dam built across a river to feed irrigation canals
 - (B) a counted era or calendar reckoned from a fixed starting event
 - (C) a dome-shaped Buddhist shrine ringed with carved railings
 - (D) a marriage alliance binding two royal houses together
- 46.** Among the rulers of this age, the one most closely associated with the Kushanas is:
- (A) Kanishka
 - (B) Kharavela
 - (C) Pushyamitra
 - (D) Gautamiputra
- 47.** The Kushanas' exceptional wealth and importance rested chiefly on their command of:
- (A) the Grand Anicut dam on the Kaveri delta
 - (B) the overland Silk Route linking China to the Mediterranean
 - (C) the carved railings of the Bharhut Stupa
 - (D) the Sangam poetry academies of the Tamil south
- 48.** The 'Silk Route' is most precisely described as:

- (A) a network of overland trade routes joining China to the Mediterranean through Central Asia
- (B) a sea lane running directly from the Deccan to Rome
- (C) a road the Cholas built across the Kaveri delta
- (D) a touring circuit followed by Tamil Sangam poets

49. Kanishka's coins carry his titles alongside images of many different gods. To a historian these coins are most useful for revealing:

- (A) that he had rejected every form of religion outright
- (B) that he ruled the Tamil far south of the peninsula
- (C) his royal titles and the diversity of deities he honoured
- (D) that he took no part in any kind of trade

50. The Kushanas dominating the LAND Silk Route while the Satavahanas and Tamil kingdoms traded by SEA together show that, in this age, India was:

- (A) limited to trade within its own villages
- (B) completely cut off from the outside world
- (C) tied into long-distance trade by both land and sea
- (D) dependent on a single trade route for everything

51. Two sculptures sit side by side: one shows the Buddha in toga-like folds with wavy hair; the other is a fuller, rounder figure in spotted red sandstone. They belong, respectively, to the schools of:

- | | |
|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Mathura and Gandhara | (B) Sangam and Gandhara |
| (C) Mathura and Bharhut | (D) Gandhara and Mathura |

52. A textbook lists 'Gandhara: indigenous red sandstone' and 'Mathura: Greek robes and wavy hair'. The corrected version should read:

- (A) Gandhara fused Greek forms with Buddhist subjects, while Mathura was an indigenous red-sandstone style
- (B) Gandhara was Tamil poetry while Mathura was Greek sculpture
- (C) both were purely Greek with no Indian element at all
- (D) both were styles of Tamil poetry rather than sculpture

53. Why is Gandhara art a BETTER single example of 'cultural confluence' than the indigenous Mathura style?

- (A) Gandhara was made entirely without any foreign influence whatsoever
- (B) Gandhara visibly merges a foreign Greek form with an Indian Buddhist subject, while Mathura is essentially one local tradition
- (C) Mathura was a foreign Greek style and Gandhara a purely Indian one
- (D) Gandhara was a school of Tamil poetry rather than sculpture

54. 'Cultural confluence', as the chapter uses it, is best defined as:

- (A) the total replacement of one culture by another
- (B) the blending of different traditions into new shared styles while a dominant Indian character remains
- (C) the strict keeping of every culture entirely separate
- (D) the spread of a single unchanging culture with no mixing

55. Which list contains ONLY items that can serve as physical (material) sources for this age?

- (A) coins, election ballots and newspapers
- (B) emails, photographs and passports
- (C) constitutions, voter rolls and tax records
- (D) coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures

56. The chapter stresses that without coins and inscriptions we would know far less about this age. The reason is that:

- (A) no one alive then could read or write at all
- (B) much of our evidence for its rulers, trade and religion is physical rather than written chronicle
- (C) the period left behind no buildings whatsoever
- (D) every written history of it was a translation made in Rome

57. Which sequence places these developments in correct order, earliest first?

- (A) Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the Maurya breakup, then the Satavahanas' rise
- (B) Maurya breakup, then the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's Kushana rule
- (C) the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's rule, then the Maurya breakup
- (D) Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the Satavahanas' rise, then the Maurya breakup

58. A student writes: 'This age shows that political division and cultural creativity can flourish together.' Which combination of facts BEST supports the claim?

- (A) many rival kingdoms existed at once alongside new art schools, busy trade and great Sanskrit works
- (B) the whole subcontinent was peacefully unified under one ruler who sponsored the arts
- (C) all art and trade ceased until a single large empire was restored
- (D) the foreign rulers banned every form of Indian culture during their reigns

59. Which pair correctly contrasts an INDIGENOUS power with a FOREIGN one of this age?

- (A) the Indo-Greeks versus the Kushanas, both indigenous Indian powers
- (B) the Shungas of the heartland versus the Indo-Greeks of the northwest
- (C) the Cholas versus the Pandyas, one indigenous and one foreign
- (D) the Satavahanas versus the Shungas, one foreign and one indigenous

60. Which single statement is the ODD ONE OUT because it MISDESCRIBES its subject?

- (A) the Kushanas grew rich by sea trade through the western Deccan ports
- (B) the Shungas revived Vedic ritual and adorned the Bharhut Stupa
- (C) the Satavahanas carried on sea trade evidenced by ship-coins
- (D) the Cholas built the Grand Anicut to irrigate the Kaveri delta

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	A	31	D	41	C	51	D
2	D	12	B	22	C	32	C	42	B	52	A
3	C	13	D	23	C	33	A	43	C	53	B
4	D	14	A	24	B	34	D	44	A	54	B
5	D	15	C	25	A	35	C	45	B	55	D
6	A	16	A	26	D	36	B	46	A	56	B
7	D	17	D	27	B	37	D	47	B	57	B
8	D	18	B	28	D	38	C	48	A	58	A
9	C	19	D	29	A	39	B	49	C	59	B
10	A	20	A	30	C	40	B	50	C	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The 'Dark Centuries' label is undermined by showing the age was creative and connected: flourishing art schools, trade and Sanskrit works prove vitality, not darkness. A single reunifying emperor is false (the age was defined by many competing kingdoms) and would in any case not address cultural 'darkness'. The claim that every kingdom was foreign-ruled and suppressive is false, since most powers (Shungas, Satavahanas, Tamil kingdoms) were Indian and culture flourished. Leaving behind no coins or inscriptions is the opposite of the truth, since those material remains are our chief sources for the period.

2. (D) The chapter presents an internal breakup as the cause, occurring before foreigners entered the weakened northwest; weakness precedes and enables the entry. The reverse claim that outside attack caused the collapse inverts the sequence. There was no joint Maurya-foreigner rule, and there is no account of the Mauryas inviting foreigners to defend the frontier; the frontier simply weakened after the empire fragmented.

3. (C) The argument rests purely on chronology: a cause must precede its effect, so a later invasion cannot be the cause of an earlier collapse. The claim that internal politics is 'always' more important is an overgeneralisation not made by the chapter and not what makes this particular argument valid. The invaders were a different people, not the Mauryas renamed. And the northwest had been Mauryan territory before the breakup, so that distractor is factually false.

4. (D) Pushyamitra was the Mauryan commander-in-chief who killed the last emperor from within — an internal coup — whereas the Indo-Greeks were outsiders who entered the weakened northwest. They were not two foreign invasions: Pushyamitra was an insider, not a foreigner. Neither involved inheritance or election; Pushyamitra seized the throne by force. And neither was a Tamil southern power moving north; the Indo-Greeks came from the northwest and the Shungas were of the heartland.

5. (D) The defining feature of the age is plurality: many rival kingdoms in different regions replacing the single Mauryan empire. It was not a larger single empire, nor a single foreign empire over all India, and it was certainly not stateless, since the chapter names many active kingdoms such as the Shungas, Satavahanas, Tamil kingdoms and Kushanas.

6. (A) When a marriage immediately converts enemies into allies, it is functioning as diplomacy through matrimony — the chapter's point about matrimonial alliances. Calling it purely private ignores the political effect just described. It is a marriage, not a sacrifice, and it builds alliance rather than extracting tribute.

7. (D) The ashvamedha let a king proclaim paramountcy over every land his freed horse crossed without challenge, so it parallels a public claim of supreme overlordship. It did not choose a successor, was not a marriage treaty, and did not begin a calendar — starting a dated era is the role of a samvat such as the Shaka era.

8. (D) A queen performing the kingship-claiming horse-sacrifice shows both that royal women could hold genuine authority and that the dynasty still kept Vedic ritual (since the rite is Vedic). Both inferences are valid. Denying the second is wrong because performing a Vedic sacrifice is direct evidence the ritual survived; denying the first is wrong because a sovereignty-claiming rite implies real power; and the record plainly concerns a ritual act, not trade.

9. (C) A mother-derived royal name together with a land-donating queen mother jointly point to the high standing of royal women. The name is not that of a god, and a single fact cannot establish that 'naming after gods' was a custom. 'Gautami' is a personal or lineage name, not a city. And being called 'son of Gautami' does not make the king a monk; he ruled as king.

10. (A) Mother-names for kings, queens endowing gifts, and a queen performing the sovereignty-claiming sacrifice all point to women holding real authority, directly refuting

'only kings held power'. Ship-coins, gold hoards and milestones are about trade routes, not women's power. The stupa, pillar and anicut concern religion, blending and irrigation. Sangam poems, the calendar and Kanishka's coins concern literature, timekeeping and royal religion — none speaks to royal women's authority.

11. (C) The ashvamedha embeds a political claim in its own procedure: the king claims every land the unchallenged horse crosses, making it inherently political. It was performed by several rulers, not once in all history. It was not the only rite women performed, and the point is not that women alone performed it. And it was a Vedic sacrifice requiring priests, so the 'no priests' claim is false.

12. (B) The pairing shows religious patronage was not exclusive: a Vedic-reviving house could still support Buddhist art. It does not prove secret conversion; the stupa was genuinely Buddhist, not a relabelled temple; and Buddhism was clearly still alive, since its monuments were being adorned at the time.

13. (D) The Shungas held north and central India while the Satavahanas built their power in the Deccan. The first wrong option reverses these two regions. The Tamil far south belonged to the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas and Kalinga to Kharavela. The northwest and the Central Asian steppe were the world of foreign rulers such as the Indo-Greeks and Kushanas, not the Shungas or Satavahanas.

14. (A) A stupa is a dome-shaped Buddhist monument, such as Bharhut, often surrounded by carved railings. A river-diverting dam is an anicut, a Tamil poetry anthology is a Sangam work, and a counted era is a samvat — none of these is a stupa, and a victory pillar (like the Heliodorus pillar) is yet another distinct thing.

15. (C) The Shungas are remembered for reviving Vedic ritual and patronising the Bharhut Stupa's carvings. The Grand Anicut was a Chola irrigation work on the Kaveri. The Silk Route was the Kushanas' source of wealth. Greek-portrait coins belong to the Indo-Greeks, not the Shungas.

16. (A) The Bharhut railing is Buddhist religious art sponsored in the north-central heartland, while Indo-Greek coins are the main source for those rulers' names and faces. Neither is Mathura red-sandstone sculpture. Only the Indo-Greeks descended from Alexander's governors; the Shungas were an indigenous dynasty, so 'both foreign' is false. And neither object is a sea-trade token for Roman pepper, which is connected with the Satavahanas and Tamil kingdoms.

17. (D) Ship coins from a port point to flourishing sea trade through the Satavahanas' western Deccan ports. The image is not evidence of sea-worship, nor of losing land territory, nor of a navy against the Kushanas — the Kushanas were a northern LAND power reached by no Satavahana fleet.

18. (B) The Satavahanas prospered through Deccan sea ports, while the Kushanas controlled the overland Silk Route between China and the Mediterranean. Saying both used the land Silk Route ignores the Satavahanas' ship-coin sea trade; saying both used the sea ignores the Kushanas' inland route; and the last option simply reverses the correct pairing.

19. (D) Roman gold in Indian ports shows trade, not conquest; political rule would require signs like Roman governors or troops, which are absent. The coins were not forgeries — they are genuine Roman gold paid for Indian goods. Distance did not prevent contact, since the very coins prove goods moved between the two. And Indian kings minted at home, not in Roman mints.

20. (A) A land-grant inscription documents a concrete act in fixed wording, making it more reliable than a flattering praise-poem that might exaggerate. Poems of the age (such as the Sangam works) were preserved, so 'never written down' is false. Inscriptions were carved by craftsmen at a ruler's order, not written in the queen's own hand. And praise-poetry was not banned; Sangam verse openly praises generous chiefs.

21. (A) Kharavela ruled Kalinga and was a committed Jain, hence 'monk-king' even though he kept his throne. He did not abdicate to wander, was not a Kushana official in Gandhara (Kalinga is in the east, not the northwest), and founded no new religion; he followed the existing Jain faith.

22. (C) Hathigumpha is an inscription — writing cut into rock — and the chief source for Kharavela, illustrating reliance on inscriptions. The age did not leave continuous year-by-year court chronicles. Roman ledgers do not supply his record, and the Sangam poems are a southern Tamil tradition, not about Kalinga in the east.

23. (C) Inscriptions typically record deeds, grants and events in words (as at Hathigumpha), while coins preserve names, titles and portraits (as with the Indo-Greeks and Kanishka). Both are genuine ancient objects, not forgeries. Coins are not written chronicles, nor are inscriptions picture-only. And both clearly help identify rulers, so calling them useless is false.

24. (B) Kharavela ruled Kalinga on the eastern coast, while the Satavahanas held the Deccan plateau. The Deccan was Satavahana, not Kharavela's, and the Tamil far south belonged to the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas. The northwest and Central Asian steppe were the world of foreign rulers, and north-central India was Shunga country, not Kharavela's or the Satavahanas'.

25. (A) The three crowned kingdoms of the Tamil south were the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas. The Shungas, Satavahanas and Chedis lay in the north and Deccan and the east; the Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas were northwestern foreign rulers; and the Mauryas, Nandas and Guptas were northern imperial dynasties, not Tamil kingdoms.

26. (D) Sangam poetry sings chiefly of love, valour and generosity. It is not a manual of Vedic sacrifice, not a chronicle of the northern Kushana emperors, and not a record of Silk-Route tolls.

27. (B) Praise of chiefs for generosity shows that liberal giving was a valued royal virtue. The poems would make no sense if giving were illegal; they presuppose chiefs and unequal wealth rather than equality; and Sangam verse celebrates love, valour and generosity, not Vedic sacrifice.

28. (D) The Pandyas were a Tamil far-southern kingdom. The Cholas were also Tamil-southern, not Deccan (the Deccan was Satavahana). Kalinga was Kharavela's, not the Cheras'. And the northwest belonged to foreign rulers, not the Pandyas.

29. (A) Familiarity with Tamil goods could arise simply from commerce, so it evidences trade, not rule. Roman writers described many lands Rome never conquered, so the first distractor is false. The notes do not show Tamil kings ruling in Italy, and they do not show Romans founding the southern kingdoms — these are indigenous Tamil powers.

30. (C) The Satavahanas used Deccan ports and the Tamils used southern ports — both relied on the sea. Neither used overland routes to Rome; the land Silk Route was the Kushanas' connection to the Mediterranean, not these two southern powers'. The first two options wrongly assign a land route to one of them.

31. (D) A ship-coin (sea), Roman gold from sea commerce, and a land Silk-Route milestone together show India connected outward by both sea and land. They do not show conquest by Rome or China, contradict the idea of purely internal trade, and disprove reliance on a single route, since two different kinds of route are represented.

32. (C) The Grand Anicut is a dam built to distribute the Kaveri's water over the delta. It is not a Buddhist stupa, not a fort against Roman ships, and not a Greek victory pillar.

33. (A) By irrigating the delta into fertile rice land, the anicut underpinned Chola wealth — an irrigation work, not a military one, which is why a fort would not serve the same end. It was not a fortress, did not bar ships (it is an inland dam), and was not a boundary marker with the Pandyas.

34. (D) An anicut is a low check-dam that lifts river water into canals; the glossary has confused it with a samvat (a counted era). A dome monument is a stupa, a marriage treaty is a matrimonial alliance, and carved writing is an inscription — none of these is an anicut.

35. (C) The Indo-Greeks descended from the Greek satraps and settlers left behind after Alexander's campaigns. They were not Shungas (an indigenous heartland dynasty), not Chedis of Kalinga, and not the later Kushanas, who were a separate Central Asian people.

- 36. (B)** A Greek envoy dedicating a pillar to an Indian deity is a clear sign of cultural blending and even adoption of Indian belief. It contradicts the ideas that the Indo-Greeks forced Greek gods on Indians, shunned Indian religion, or destroyed Indian shrines — the pillar is the opposite of all three.
- 37. (D)** Because few Indo-Greek inscriptions survive, their coins are the chief source for these rulers' names and faces. The coins were genuine trade currency, not unused tokens; they were not Rome-minted; and they certainly did not carry Tamil Sangam poetry, a southern tradition unrelated to the northwestern Indo-Greeks.
- 38. (C)** The Indo-Greeks moved in because the Mauryan collapse had left the northwest frontier weak — the breakup is the underlying cause. No Chola invitation brought them, the Kushanas did not build the Silk Route to admit them, and the Shaka calendar is unrelated to their entry.
- 39. (B)** A coin combining a Greek-style portrait with an Indian deity in Indian script shows the issuer blended his own conventions with Indian ones. It refutes the idea that he rejected Indian language and gods; it does not imply a single subcontinental empire; and a coin itself shows engagement with trade and money, not indifference.
- 40. (B)** The chapter's central theme is that the foreign rulers were mostly absorbed, with Indian culture staying dominant. They did not wipe out Indian culture, did not remain wholly separate (Heliodorus and Gandhara art show mixing), and never ruled the whole subcontinent as one empire.
- 41. (C)** The foreign rulers are treated as contributors precisely because Indian culture remained dominant and absorbed what they brought, so both statements are true and the reason explains the assertion. The reason is not false (absorption is the chapter's theme), and the assertion is not false (they were largely integrated, not erasers), so the partial and wholly-false options fail.
- 42. (B)** Indian themes at the core of foreign rulers' coins and art show India absorbed and transformed the newcomers. It did not expel them by force (their objects survive and were patronised), was not fully Hellenised (Indian themes remained central), and clearly did not halt art — the art is the very evidence.
- 43. (C)** The Shakas are also called Indo-Scythians. The Indo-Greeks were a separate people of Alexandrian descent; 'Indo-Romans' is not a ruling group; and 'Indo-Cholas' is not a real term, the Cholas being an indigenous Tamil dynasty.
- 44. (A)** A still-used Shaka-based calendar shows the period left enduring legacies, not just ruins. It contradicts the claims that nothing survived, that Romans created it, and that the age stood apart from Indian traditions — a calendar woven into Indian life proves the opposite.

45. (B) A samvat is a counted calendar era beginning from a fixed point, as with the Shaka era. A river dam is an anicut, a dome shrine is a stupa, and a royal marriage is a matrimonial alliance — none of these is a samvat.

46. (A) Kanishka is the famous Kushana ruler. Kharavela ruled Kalinga, Pushyamitra founded the Shungas, and Gautamiputra was a Satavahana — none of them Kushana.

47. (B) The Kushanas grew rich by controlling the overland Silk Route between China and the Mediterranean. The Grand Anicut was a Chola irrigation work, the Bharhut railings were Shunga-era Buddhist art, and the Sangam academies were a Tamil literary tradition — none was a Kushana source of wealth.

48. (A) The Silk Route was a web of land routes across Central Asia linking China and the Mediterranean. It was not a Deccan-to-Rome sea lane (that was Satavahana sea trade), not a Chola delta road, and not a poets' circuit.

49. (C) Coins showing his titles and a variety of gods reveal Kanishka's styling and the many faiths he patronised. They do not show rejection of religion (the many gods prove the opposite), do not place him in the Tamil south (he was a northern Kushana), and do not suggest he avoided trade — coinage itself implies commerce.

50. (C) Land trade via the Silk Route plus sea trade from Deccan and southern ports together show India linked outward by both land and sea. This refutes the ideas that trade was only village-level, that India was isolated, or that it relied on one route alone — two distinct kinds of route operated at once.

51. (D) Greek-style robes and wavy hair mark the Greco-Buddhist Gandhara school, while fuller figures in spotted red sandstone mark the indigenous Mathura school. Reversing them is the classic trap. 'Sangam' is Tamil poetry, not sculpture, and 'Bharhut' names a stupa site, not the red-sandstone school, which is Mathura.

52. (A) The textbook has swapped the two: Gandhara is the Greco-Buddhist style and Mathura the indigenous red-sandstone style. Neither is Tamil poetry; Mathura is not purely Greek (it is indigenous); and both are sculpture, not poetry.

53. (B) Confluence means traditions blending; Gandhara plainly fuses Greek form with Indian Buddhist content, so it shows confluence more clearly than the largely indigenous Mathura style. Gandhara was not influence-free (it is plainly Hellenistic in form), the styles are not reversed (Gandhara is the blended one, Mathura the indigenous one), and Gandhara is sculpture, not Tamil poetry.

54. (B) Cultural confluence means traditions merge into shared forms while the local Indian character stays dominant, as in Gandhara art. It is not the destruction or replacement of one culture, not strict separation, and not the spread of one unchanging culture — confluence requires mixing and a surviving local core.

55. (D) Coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures are genuine material remains from the period. Election ballots, newspapers, emails, photographs, passports, constitutions, voter rolls and tax records are all modern items that did not exist then and cannot be physical sources for it.

56. (B) Coins and inscriptions are physical sources that carry much of what we know, because continuous written chronicles are scarce for the age. People could read and write (the inscriptions prove it), buildings like stupas do survive, and the histories were not Roman translations — the point is the reliance on material evidence.

57. (B) The Mauryan breakup came first; the Satavahanas rose in the post-Mauryan Deccan; Kanishka's Kushana power came later still. The other orderings wrongly place Kanishka or the Satavahanas before the Mauryan breakup, which contradicts the chapter's chronology.

58. (A) The thesis needs BOTH division and creativity: many rival kingdoms coexisting with flourishing art, trade and Sanskrit works supplies both. A peaceful single empire removes the 'division' the student is arguing for; art and trade did not cease; and the foreign rulers did not ban Indian culture, since they were absorbed by it.

59. (B) The Shungas were an indigenous heartland dynasty while the Indo-Greeks were foreigners in the northwest, so this pair correctly contrasts indigenous with foreign. The Indo-Greeks and Kushanas were both foreign, not indigenous. The Cholas and Pandyas were both indigenous Tamil kingdoms. And the Satavahanas and Shungas were both indigenous Indian powers, so neither was foreign.

60. (A) The Kushanas grew rich from the overland LAND Silk Route, not from Deccan sea ports — that sea trade belonged to the Satavahanas, so this statement misdescribes its subject. The other three are accurate: the Shungas did revive Vedic ritual and adorn Bharhut, the Satavahanas' ship-coins do evidence sea trade, and the Cholas did build the Grand Anicut to water the Kaveri delta.